

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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PROTECT YOUR "TURTLE-DOVE"

OUR FOCUS

DO NOT HAND OVER, SURRENDER OR EXPOSE "YOUR TURTLE-DOVE" TO THAT WHICH IS HARMFUL AND DESTRUCTIVE.

Psalms 74:19 Oh, do not deliver the life of YOUR TURTLEDOVE to the wild beast! Do not forget the life of your poor forever. NKJV

Psalms 74:19 Do not hand the life of YOUR DOVE over to a wild animal! Do not continue to disregard the lives of your oppressed people! NET

Psalms 74:19-22

19 Don't let these wild beasts destroy YOUR TURTLEDOVES. Don't forget your suffering people forever.

20 Remember your covenant promises, for the land is full of darkness and violence!

21 Don't let the downtrodden be humiliated again. Instead, let the poor and needy praise your name.

22 Arise, O God, and defend your CAUSE. Remember how these fools insult you all day long. NLT

- This phrase **Psalm 74:19** "O deliver not the soul of thy turtle dove to the multitude of the wicked: forget not the congregation of thy poor forever," – IS A PLEA TO GOD FOR PROTECTION AND REMEMBRANCE.
- THIS IS A PETITION BY THE WRITER (ASAPH) TO GOD TO PROTECT HIS PEOPLE ISRAEL EVEN THOUGH THEY ARE STILL NOT WALKING IN GOD'S WAYS.
- IT'S A PRAYER FOR THOSE WHO ARE VULNERABLE (ISRAEL), comparing them to a gentle turtle dove and asking God not to hand them over to their enemies, the wicked multitude. AND EMPHASIZES the importance of NOT FORGETTING the poor and afflicted, highlighting Israel's persistent suffering and NEED FOR DIVINE INTERVENTION.

AN OVERVIEW

"O deliver not the soul of thy turtle dove...":

THE "TURTLE DOVE"

- The "turtle dove" is a symbol of **innocence, gentleness, and vulnerability**, often used to represent **God's people**, particularly the Israelites.
- **THE PLEA** is for God to **protect** their lives and **not allow** them to be **harmed** by their enemies.

"...to the multitude of the wicked":

THE MULTITUDE OF THE WICKED":

- This refers to the enemies of God's people, described as a cruel and unrepentant group.

"Forget not the congregation of thy poor forever":

THE CONGREGATION OF THY POOR

- Highlights God's ongoing responsibility to REMEMBER and CARE for His people, particularly the poor and afflicted.
- It expresses a deep concern that they might be forgotten or abandoned by God during their suffering.
- The verse is a prayer of passionate GRIEF and regret together with TRUST, acknowledging the suffering of God's people and their vulnerability while also expressing FAITH in God's ability and willingness to PROTECT and REMEMBER them.

- IT IS A REMINDER THAT **GOD'S PEOPLE, EVEN IN THEIR WEAKNESS AND AFFLICTION, ARE PRECIOUS TO HIM** AND SHOULD NOT BE FORGOTTEN.
- Psalm 74:19 is **a heartfelt plea** from the psalmist Asaph, asking God to **protect** His people. In this verse, Asaph uses the **imagery of a gentle dove in danger** to describe **the vulnerability of Israel**.
- He asks God not to abandon His "afflicted people," and showing a deep dependence on the need for God's mercy and protection.

DESCRIPTION.

A **TURTLEDOVE** IN THE BIBLE

- ◆ The **TURTLEDOVE** and the **PIGEON** **were the only birds permitted to be offered in SACRIFICE** (Leviticus 1:14; 5:7; 14:22; 15:14; 29)
- ◆ **THE TURTLE-DOVE** – it has a **peculiar, peaceful and gentle** habit: **PEACEFULNESS** and **GENTLENESS**.
- ◆ **THE TURTLEDOVE** speaks of something that **is loved** – an object of **AFFECTION**.

THE **DOVE** IN CHRISTIANITY

- ◆ In the Bible refers to **doves (turtledoves)** as a symbol of **GENTLENESS, PURITY, INNOCENCE and PEACE**.
- ◆ **THESE ARE THE FUNDAMENTAL CHARACTERISTICS OF THE TURTLE DOVE.**

THE DOVE in both Old & New Testaments is a powerful symbol, representing the following **characteristics**.

PEACE & RECONCILIATION

It is seen when Noah sends out a dove after the flood, and it returns with an olive branch, signifying the receding of the waters and God's covenant with humanity.

PURITY & INNOCENCE

Doves were also used in sacrificial offerings, highlighting their association with purity and innocence.

GENTLENESS & HARMLESSNESS

The dove's gentle nature is also noted, making it a fitting symbol for God's character and for believers to emulate.

HUMILITY

The dove is portrayed as a humble creature, not boastful or proud.

New Testament:

THE HOLY SPIRIT

The dove is most famously linked to the Holy Spirit and God's anointing, particularly when it descends upon Jesus during his baptism.

LOVE & DEVOTION

In the Song of Solomon, the dove is used as a metaphor for love and devotion, highlighting qualities of beauty, gentleness, and faithfulness.

APPLICATION – for us

Is for us to make every effort for these **QUALITIES** and **ATTITUDES** of the **turtledove** to be an integral part of our lives expressed **BEFORE GOD** and **PEOPLE**, especially those who are oppressed and needy (poor). **Is for us** to **MAINTAIN** and **PROTECT** those **qualities** and **attitudes**.

WE ARE TO PROTECT

- ◆ **OUR PEACEFUL AND GENTLE MANNER** (not anger, etc.)
- ◆ **OUR INNOCENCE, OUR ATTITUDE OF HAVING NO GUILE.** (No guile means NO DUPLICITY, no DECEIT, no CRAFTINESS, no CUNNINGNESS) –
- ◆ **OUR GOOD ATTITUDE** BY NOT ARGUING, CONTESTING OR ATTRIBUTING BLAME.

*Psalm 74:19, "O deliver not the soul of thy turtledove unto the multitude of the wicked: forget not the congregation of thy poor for ever," **is a plea to God to protect his people** from their enemies and not to forget them in their suffering. **The "turtledove" and "poor" are symbolic of the people of Israel who are vulnerable and afflicted.***

◆ **THE PRAYER/PLEA**

"Forget not the congregation (or, the multitude) of thy poor forever". Psalm 74:19

- ◆ **Expressing a deep trust (faith) in God's Power and for His intervention in their time of distress.**
- ◆ **The real possibility that the multitude of God's poor might be carried off into a cruel captivity, or else left as a miserable remnant in an exhausted and desolated land - in either case needing much of God's protection and "remembrance."**

Amen Ps Barry